

UK & EU Pharma Compliance Guide 2026

The frameworks, dates and disclosure deadlines that shape pharmaceutical compliance in the UK and Europe in 2026, with a one-line summary of each and a link to the official source.

For: Compliance, legal and leadership teams planning the year ahead across the UK and European markets.

United Kingdom

- The 2024 ABPI Code of Practice took effect on 1 October 2024, with a transition period to 31 December 2024. It is administered by the PMCPA independently of the ABPI. [\[PMCPA\]](#)
- The PMCPA's social media guidance was updated in February 2026. [\[PMCPA\]](#)
- Industry payments to UK healthcare professionals and organisations are published on Disclosure UK, the ABPI's database. [\[ABPI\]](#)
- Part 14 of the Human Medicines Regulations 2012 sets the legal rules on advertising medicines; the MHRA Blue Guide explains how the MHRA applies them. [\[legislation.gov.uk; MHRA\]](#)
- Section 7 of the Bribery Act 2010: a commercial organisation can be liable for failing to prevent bribery by associated persons, unless it had adequate procedures. [\[legislation.gov.uk\]](#)
- The failure to prevent fraud offence under the Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act 2023 has applied since 1 September 2025. [\[GOV.UK\]](#)
- The Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 amends, but does not replace, the UK GDPR, the Data Protection Act 2018 and PECR; its changes were phased in between June 2025 and June 2026. [\[ICO\]](#)

European Union

- The EFPIA Code of Practice (2026 edition) sets standards for interactions with HCPs, HCOs and patient organisations. Member associations transpose it into national codes and may adopt stricter standards. [\[EFPIA\]](#)
- EFPIA disclosure: transfers of value are disclosed annually for each calendar year, within six months of the year end; disclosures stay public for at least three years and records are kept for at least five. [\[EFPIA Code\]](#)
- Directive 2001/83/EC sets the EU framework for medicines advertising and inducements that national laws implement. [\[EUR-Lex\]](#)
- The EU AI Act, Regulation (EU) 2024/1689, applies alongside the GDPR, the EU Data Act and, where AI forms part of a medical device or diagnostic, the MDR and IVDR. [\[EUR-Lex\]](#)
- Named disclosure of HCPs needs a lawful basis under the GDPR: EFPIA's training material identifies individual consent or legitimate interest, with a documented process. [\[EFPIA\]](#)

Country notes

- France: the anti-gift regime (Ordonnance 2017-49; decree 2020-730 applying since 1 October 2020), Loi Bertrand disclosure on Transparence Santé, prior ANSM advertising visas and Sapin II Article 17. [\[Légifrance; ANSM\]](#)

- Germany: the FSA codes for member companies, HWG § 7 on gifts and promotional benefits, and the healthcare anti-corruption offences in §§ 299a–299b StGB. [[FSA](#); [gesetze-im-internet.de](#)]
- Spain: incentives prohibited under Article 4.6 of RDL 1/2015; RD 1416/1994 on HCP advertising and hospitality; Farmaindustria Code (2025 edition), with transfers of value published each June. [[BOE](#); [Farmaindustria](#)]
- Italy: D.Lgs. 219/2006 on gifts (Art. 123) and AIFA notification of congresses at least 60 days ahead (Art. 124); Farmaindustria disclosure by 30 June; the Sunshine Act (Legge 62/2022) register, whose operational status should be checked. [[AIFA](#); [Farmaindustria](#)]
- Netherlands: Geneesmiddelenwet Article 94 on inducements, IGJ low-value limits of €50 per gift and €150 a year, and Transparantieregister Zorg reporting before 1 June for relationships of at least €500 a year. [[wetten.overheid.nl](#); [IGJ](#); [Transparantieregister](#)]
- Portugal: declarations of economic advantages under Article 159 of the Estatuto do Medicamento through INFARMED's transparency platform. [[INFARMED](#)]
- Ireland: HPRa supervision of medicines advertising and the IPHA Code of Practice, including disclosure of financial interactions. [[HPRa](#); [IPHA](#)]
- Sweden: Lif's ethical rules (LER), English edition effective 1 February 2026; searchable, downloadable disclosure reports from the 2027 publication of 2026 transfers. [[Lif](#)]

Disclosure calendar

- Before 1 June: Netherlands, report to the Transparantieregister Zorg (published mid-July). [[Transparantieregister](#)]
- June: Spain, Farmaindustria Code disclosures published on company websites. [[Farmaindustria](#)]
- By 30 June: EFPIA Code disclosure deadline (six months after year end); Italy, Farmaindustria disclosures. [[EFPIA](#); [Farmaindustria](#)]

Informational summary based on official sources checked in September 2026, not legal advice. Confirm current requirements for your organisation, markets and activities.

Official sources: [pmcpa.org.uk](#) · [abpi.org.uk](#) · [legislation.gov.uk](#) · [gov.uk](#) · [ico.org.uk](#) · [efpia.eu](#) · [eur-lex.europa.eu](#) · [legifrance.gouv.fr](#) · [ansm.sante.fr](#) · [fsa-pharma.de](#) · [gesetze-im-internet.de](#) · [boe.es](#) · [farmaindustria.es](#) · [aifa.gov.it](#) · [farmaindustria.it](#) · [wetten.overheid.nl](#) · [igj.nl](#) · [transparantieregister.nl](#) · [infarmed.pt](#) · [hpra.ie](#) · [ipha.ie](#) · [lif.se](#). Links to each source are in our country guides at [eunomiapharmaservices.com/legal-mandates](#).

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